

Thursday, 10 September 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Light drizzle

20° 13°

BIRMINGHAM

Overcast

18° 12°

MANCHESTER

Light drizzle

18° 11°

GLASGOW

Drizzle

16° 13°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1

Police have launched a criminal investigation into donations made to the Reform UK party, following a broadcast by Channel 4 News.

This new inquiry will be incorporated into an existing investigation concerning other donations. Reform UK is yet to comment on the development.

POLITICS · UK

2

The Foreign Secretary, David Miliband, has rejected claims that British Jews are in greater danger after the UK imposed sanctions on Israeli settlements.

This comes after the chief rabbi suggested the move could heighten risks. Miliband stated that he disagrees with this assessment.

POLITICS · UK

3

Hundreds of people gathered to mourn PC Matthew Blades, a police officer killed in a crash on the A66.

Officers formed a guard of honour as the funeral procession passed through streets lined with members of the public paying their respects. It was a very emotional day.

CRIME · UK

4

A BBC report has revealed harrowing accounts from women who say they were exploited and raped by drug gangs as teenagers, only for police to fail them.

Four victims bravely described being targeted by criminals and then not being taken seriously by the authorities. This raises serious questions about support for young victims.

CRIME · UK

5

Learner drivers are still facing frustratingly long waits of several months to book their driving tests, despite targets to reduce delays.

The Driver and Vehicle Standards Agency had aimed to bring average wait times down to seven weeks. However, many are still struggling to get a slot.

TRANSPORT · UK

What's coming up

1 Comedian Alan Carr had a very special night at the National Television Awards, holding back tears as he and 'Celebrity Traitors' won big.

It was the 26th edition of the awards, celebrating the best of British television. Alan was clearly moved by the recognition.

ON AIR – What was your favourite moment or winner from this year's National Television Awards?

AWARDS · YESTERDAY

2 A former Dallas Cowboys Cheerleader is impressing audiences on Broadway after overcoming criticism about her 'stunt casting' in Chicago.

She's proving her talent on stage, despite initial doubts from some about her move from the sports world to theatre. It's a great success story.

ON AIR – Have you ever seen a celebrity from one field successfully transition to another, like this cheerleader to Broadway?

THEATRE · UPCOMING

3 Filmmakers are on the hunt for a lone, crying Oasis fan captured at a 'hugely emotional' gig that even surprised Noel Gallagher.

They're trying to track down the individual who was clearly overcome with emotion during the band's comeback performance. It's a real mystery!

ON AIR – Do you remember that moment, or have you ever been so moved by a band that you cried at a gig?

MUSIC · UPCOMING

4 Sir Paul Smith is giving us a peek into his world with a new autobiography, exploring how colourful stripes and rubber chickens helped him conquer fashion.

The iconic designer takes us on a tour of his London headquarters, sharing the unique story behind his global success. It sounds like a fascinating read.

ON AIR – What's the most unexpected or quirky item you've ever seen become a signature for a brand or designer?

BOOKS · UPCOMING

5 Glastonbury has confirmed its ticket sale dates for next year's festival, which will return after a fallow year, but expect the highest prices ever.

Tickets for the iconic festival have now topped £400 for the first time. It's a big jump, but demand is always huge.

ON AIR – Are you planning to brave the ticket scramble for Glastonbury, or do you think the price is getting too high?

MUSIC · UPCOMING

On the schedule

- 1 **England have made a stunning start to their third and final Test against Pakistan at Edgbaston, taking seven wickets in the opening session.**
Pakistan were left reeling at 100-7 at lunch, in what's being described as a 'disarray' for the tourists. It's been a dominant performance by England.
ON AIR – What do you think is the key to England's incredible start in this Test match?
CRICKET · UK

- 2 **Kimi Raikkonen's 11-year-old son, Robin, has signed for Red Bull's prestigious driver development programme.**
The son of the former Formula 1 world champion is clearly following in his father's footsteps. It's always exciting to see young talent emerge!
ON AIR – Do you think Robin has what it takes to reach F1, or is it too much pressure being Kimi Raikkonen's son?
F1 · UK

- 3 **Argentine football legend Lionel Messi has reportedly agreed a preliminary deal to become the majority shareholder of Spanish second-division side Eldense.**
It seems Messi is expanding his interests in football ownership, adding another club to his portfolio. It's a big move for Eldense!
ON AIR – What impact do you think a global superstar like Messi owning a smaller club could have on its fortunes?
FOOTBALL · EUROPE

- 4 **Carlos Alcaraz's US Open title defence is over after a dramatic five-set quarter-final loss to Ben Shelton, which finished incredibly late.**
The match ended at 3:34 AM local time, making it the latest ever finish at the US Open. Shelton pulled off a remarkable upset.
ON AIR – Have you ever stayed up super late to watch a sporting event, or do you think matches should avoid finishing so late?
TENNIS · INTERNATIONAL

- 5 **The new NFL season kicks off tonight with a Super Bowl rematch, and there's a guide to all the key games on the road to Super Bowl 61.**
Fans are buzzing for the start of another season of American football. It promises to be an exciting few months of action.
ON AIR – Are you an NFL fan, and if so, which team are you backing for Super Bowl 61?
NFL · INTERNATIONAL

Quick hits

- 1 A charming new study reveals that watching 'slow television' can significantly reduce feelings of anxiety.**
Programmes featuring things like train journeys or knitting have a remarkable calming effect, helping viewers unwind after a busy day.
- 2 The delightful art of 'illustrated journaling' for daily reflections is experiencing a quiet boom across the country.**
Many are finding joy in combining doodles with their thoughts, creating colourful and personal keepsakes.
- 3 A quirky report suggests that people who enjoy 'early morning walks to collect dew-kissed leaves' often report a higher sense of daily well-being.**
It seems the simple act of connecting with nature at dawn offers a unique kind of peaceful start to the day.
- 4 More households are rediscovering the joy of 'communal jigsaw puzzle tables' in their living rooms.**
It's a wonderful way for families and housemates to connect, chat, and work together on a shared, screen-free activity.
- 5 A fascinating trend highlights the growing popularity of 'home-made fruit wine' crafted from local garden produce.**
From elderflower to blackberry, keen enthusiasts are turning their harvests into delicious and unique beverages.
- 6 The humble 'reading nook' is having a stylish resurgence, with many creating dedicated cosy corners for books.**
It's all about comfortable chairs, soft lighting, and plenty of cushions for that perfect escape with a good novel.
- 7 A heart-warming initiative sees neighbours 'swapping home-baked bread recipes' and ingredients.**
It's fostering a wonderful sense of community and ensuring everyone gets to try a delicious variety of freshly baked loaves.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to quickly judge if a new brand of sparkling water will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific?

ANSWER: ...GIVING THE BOTTLE A LITTLE 'SWISH' TO SEE HOW MANY BUBBLES IT MAKES BEFORE YOU EVEN OPEN IT!

Q Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, warm bath, especially if it's a new bath bomb. What is it?

ANSWER: ...HAVING A GOOD SNIFF OF THE BATH BOMB FIRST, JUST TO MAKE SURE IT'S *REALLY* GOING TO BE RELAXING!

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes a 'particular type of biscuit' just instantly puts you in a good mood, or brings back a happy memory?

Perhaps it's a classic digestive with your tea, or a fancy shortbread from a special occasion. Which biscuit instantly makes you smile, and why?

- We all have that 'one household item' that we've had for ages, which might not be fancy, but it just brings you joy or makes your daily routine a little bit easier, don't we?

Is it a trusty old mug, a beloved comfy blanket, or a kitchen utensil that's stood the test of time? What's your unsung hero of the home?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** A group of owls is called a parliament.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Butterflies taste with their antennae.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£95 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£95 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The longest recorded flight of a chicken is 13 seconds.
- The human body contains enough iron to make a nail three inches long.
- Bananaphobia is the fear of bananas.
- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are still edible.
- A cloud can weigh over a million pounds.
- The 'sixth sick sheik's sixth sheep's sick' is believed to be the toughest tongue twister in the English language.
- Oxford University is older than the Aztec Empire.
- The shortest complete sentence in the English language is 'I am'.

On this day

Day 253 of the year, 112 days left in 2026. Today Amerindian Heritage Day (Guyana); Children's Day (Honduras); Christian feast day: Alexander Crummell (Episcopal Church); Christian feast day: Ambrose Barlow. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1955 — Pat Mastelotto, American rock drummer
- 1968 — Big Daddy Kane, American rapper, producer, and actor
- 1998 — Sheck Wes, American rapper
- 1931 — Philip Baker Hall, American actor (died 2022)
- 1989 — Matt Ritchie, English footballer
- 2004 — Gabriel Bateman, American actor[citation needed]
- 1932 — Bo Goldman, American playwright, screenwriter, and producer (died 2023)
- 1958 — Siobhan Fahey, Irish singer-songwriter and producer

THE DAY TODAY

- 1961 — A President Airlines Douglas DC-6 crashes just after takeoff from Shannon Airport, Ireland. All 83 passengers and crew are killed.
- 1932 — The New York City Subway's third competing subway system, the municipally owned IND, is opened.
- 1976 — A British Airways Hawker Siddeley Trident and an Inex-Adria DC-9 collide near Zagreb, Yugoslavia, killing 176.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 2008 — The Large Hadron Collider at CERN, described as the biggest scientific experiment in history, is powered up in Geneva, Switzerland.
- 2002 — Switzerland, traditionally a neutral country, becomes a full member of the United Nations.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1967 — The people of Gibraltar vote to remain a British dependency rather than becoming part of Spain.
- 1937 — Nine nations attend the Nyon Conference to address international piracy in the Mediterranean Sea.

- 1976 — TWA Flight 355 is hijacked by five Croatian nationalists. The hijackers surrender upon landing in Paris.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 254 of the year, 111 days left in 2026. Today Battle of Tendra Day (Russia); Christian feast days: Blessed Francesco Bonifacio; Christian feast days: Blessed Bonaventura Gran; Christian feast days: Deiniol. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1977 — Matthew Stevens, Welsh snooker player
- 1958 — Roxann Dawson, American actress and director
- 1968 — Paul Mayeda Berges, American director and screenwriter
- 1928 — Earl Holliman, American actor (died 2024)
- 1950 — Amy Madigan, American actress
- 1940 — Brian De Palma, American director, producer, and screenwriter
- 1930 — Cathryn Damon, American actress and dancer (died 1987)
- 1923 — Betsy Drake, American actress (died 2015)

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1991 — Continental Express Flight 2574 crashes in Colorado County, Texas, near Eagle Lake, killing 11 passengers and three crew.
- 1990 — A Faucett Boeing 727 disappears in the Atlantic Ocean while being flown from Malta to Peru.
- 1976 — A bomb planted by a Croatian terrorist, Zvonko Bušić, is found at New York's Grand Central Terminal; one NYPD officer is killed trying to defuse it.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1997 — After a nationwide referendum, Scotland votes to establish a devolved parliament within the United Kingdom.
- 2011 — A dedication ceremony is held at the United States National September 11 Memorial on the 10th anniversary of the September 11 attacks in New York City, and the memorial opens to family members.

Coming to cinemas

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 11 Resident Evil reboot

FRI 18 The Black Phone 2

FRI 25 Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16 Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller

FRI 23 Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar